

Dowe Flats

A Broken Promise 25 Years In the Making



A promise made must
be a promise kept.

Aristotle

A 25 Year Promise...

- [SU-93-14 and Resolution 94-81](#) are *very clear*: **25 years maximum of mining**, followed by **maximum 3 year** reclamation period; mining of Dowe Flats began in **1997**
- Boulder County [owns purchase options](#) exercisable **Dec 31, 2024** (after 3 yrs reclamation)
- Dowe Flats [had a non-mining covenant](#) running with the land, commencing at midnight on **Dec 31, 2021**; CEMEX managed to [obtain this covenant and extinguish](#)
- [Computer generated images](#) were created to show what Dowe Flats would look like in 25 years (post-reclamation) and presented to **officials and the public**
- Multiple Surveys created based upon the 25 Year Life-of-Mine Provision
 - [Black Footed Ferret Survey](#) (1993)
 - [Mining & Reclamation Report](#) (1993)
 - [Visual Impact Analysis](#) (1993)
- In 1994, [a stated goal of Dowe Flats was](#) the “during the 25 year life-of-mineit would ensure long-term stability of the cement plant...the mine plan would provide cement plant reserves for 25 years.”

In **2002** Mr. **John Lohr, Cemex's Plant Manager**, tells the Daily Camera, the community, and County officials: "We're excited about the **prospect** [Dowe Flats] because basically **it ensures the entire valley will be open space**".

In **2002**, the Daily Camera, Amy Brawley, Acquisitions Manager for **Boulder County Parks & Open Space** affirms that: "...by purchasing this land & connecting the open space areas, **the county helps protect & preserve an important habitat for wildlife...**"

**What We Were Promised
(Dowe Flats Open Space by 2025)**



Source: [Dowe Flats Mining, Reclamation and Water Storage Plan, May 3, 1993](#)

**What We Are Getting
(Dowe Flats Still Being Mined in 2025)**



Source: [Google Earth](#)

People with good intentions
make promises.

People with good character
keep them.

- Unknown

BREAKING A
PROMISE BREAKS
TRUST, AND ONCE IT
IS BROKEN IT IS
VERY HARD TO PUT
BACK TOGETHER
AGAIN.

JO OWEN

WWW.WOW4U.COM

Dear Boulder County Commissioners:

No Matter How Much Free Land or
Financial Incentives You Are Offered...

You Must Keep Your Promise.

Sincerely, Your Residents

Before Sep 14th

Email Boulder County Commissioners
commissioners@bouldercounty.org

Subject Line: SU-22-0003

CC: planner@bouldercounty.org

Appendix

Existing Valley



Dowe Flats in 1993

Source: [Dowe Flats Mining, Reclamation and Water Storage Plan, May 3, 1993](#)

Mining and reclamation complete - 25 years +



Dowe Flats in 25
Years after Mining
and Reclamation
Complete

*Computer generated
in 1993

Source: [Dowe Flats Mining,
Reclamation and Water
Storage Plan, May 3, 1993](#)



Dowe Flats today
and until 2037 years
if new Special Use is
Approved

[Source: Google Earth](#)